



CREATE CONTENT

- **Post compelling** content.
- **Plan consistent**, regular, scheduled content updates.
- **Personalize** content to suit your target audience.
- **Use strong images** or lively infographics to draw attention.
- **Tailor** content to the platform but keep a clear brand focus.



MAKING IT WORK

- **Use free online tools** and analytics (see pp.212–215) initially to track and measure performance of social media interactions.
- **Respond to any negative comments** on sites in a positive way, and avoid defensive or inflammatory replies.
- **Add your social networking profile** links to your website, email signature, promotional materials, stationery, and business cards.

Follow the trends

- **Identify “influencers”**—people with a large social media following—in areas relevant to your business and that best match your brand.
- **Subscribe to social media blogs** (online articles and commentaries) to learn about the latest trends.
- **Look online at Google Trends** for a broad view of the topics that are the most searched for online.
- **Join relevant online forums** to see what members are talking about and interested in. Start and lead threads on subjects involving your business.

Invest in advertising

- **Choose the most relevant platform** to your business and customers, and try to steer users, or “traffic,” to your own website.
- **Use online ads** that target buyers by geography, shopping patterns, personal interests, and other demographic pointers.
- **Create compelling offers** to attract attention and customer interaction.
- **Make sure ads** have a clear, simple graphic design, punchy memorable headlines, or both.

If you have a website

- **Link to your website store**, which is where customer sales are actually made.
- **Keep website content** up to date, with news, blogs, new products, and trends.
- **Promote website content**, such as blog posts and images, on your social media platforms to generate website traffic.
- **Encourage the sharing** of website content on social media by adding “sharing” tools to web pages that link to Facebook, Instagram, and other sites.



POTENTIAL CUSTOMERS

Raising your profile will attract new customers, who may spread the word about you.

